Huang Yufan

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Research interests: Immersive and Embodied Interaction; Human–AI Interaction; Social Interaction in Games

EDUCATION

Donghua University, China 09/2021-06/2025
BA Product Design, Average Marks: 88/100 (Rank: Top 20%)
Honours: Second Prize Scholarship, First Prize, Second Prize, and Third Prize, 2024 Milan Design Week China Non-Thematic Track for University Design Disciplines

KTH Royal Institute of Technology, Sweden 09/2025-06/2027
MSc Interactive Media Technology, Full level A untill now

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

Agent Politeness, Spatial Decision-Making, and Cognitive Load in VR

Embodied Social Agents Lab (ESAL), KTH Royal Institute of Technology -- Research Intern | Jun 2026 - Present

- Designed and developed a Unity-based VR experimental platform to investigate how embodied social agents' politeness strategies influence human spatial decision-making and cognitive load.
- Implemented multi-stage agent requests and trial transitions, integrating physiological data collection with logging of trial events and participants' spatial choices.
- Lead experimental data collection and analysis, combining behavioural and physiological measures to examine participants' responses to agent interactions.
- First author of a methodology paper proposal submitted to **HCII 2027**; full manuscript in preparation.

Visible Self-Repair in Conversational AI Agents

Studio for Narrative Spaces, City University of Hong Kong -- Research Intern (remote) | Jun 2026 - Sep 2026

- Collaboratively designed a controlled study with 60 participants to investigate how visible self-repair in conversational AI agents affects user perceptions and behaviour.
- Led study coordination and experimental sessions.
- Built a web-based backend for interaction-log collection and conducted the primary analysis of behavioural log data.
- Co-wrote the manuscript as a co-first author, with responsibility for key findings and conclusions, research figures, and the accompanying video; submitted to **CHI 2027**.

Lying in Games: Exploring Prosocial Lying

In collaboration with Studio for Narrative Spaces, City University of Hong Kong | Sep2026 - Present

- Investigating how players' choices to tell prosocial lies to NPCs in Stardew Valley shape their perceptions and subsequent in-game behaviour, with potential implications for real-world behaviour.
- Co-authoring a manuscript for planned submission to **CHI PLAY 2027**.

PUBLICATIONS

[1] Chen, Y., Xu, M., **Huang, Y.**, et al. Cooling performance of phase change ventilation clothing in construction work. Advanced Textile Technology, 2025, 33(7): 109–116. (in Chinese)

[2] Tao, C., **Huang, Y.**, et al. Interpretation of the University Library New Intelligent Reading Space from the Perspective of Service Design. Theory and Practice of Contemporary Education, 2025, 17(4): 89–95. (in Chinese)

PATENTS

Huang, Y. (Sole Inventor). Glass Window Facade Structure for Preventing Bird–Window Collisions. Design Patent, China National Intellectual Property Administration (CNIPA), 2025. Patent No. ZL 2024 3 0620185.0.

PRACTICAL EXPERIENCES

HEXAGON

Product Management Internship – Education Solutions Department | Jun 2024 - Sept 2024

- Contributed to the design of educational products and virtual simulation prototypes, focusing on user interaction and usability.
- Created digital personas for Hexagon Education's platform.

SKILLS

Programming & Tools: Unity (C#), Python, R, SPSS, Arduino.
Design: Rhino, Blender, Adobe Creative Cloud.
Research: Experimental Design, User Studies, Behavioural Data Analysis.